



Khatron ke Khiladi



Akshay Kumar's *tehran deviyan* go for guts and glory. They jump from buildings and leap into icy water, shouting *Jai Mata Di* and reciting the Gayatri Mantra.

"We were surprised at the stunts the girls pulled off. I kept thinking it would be too tough." Ashvini Yardi, Colors

ALPHA
WOMAN
QUOTIENT



High



Medium



Low

Africa in sometimes below zero temperatures. These were glam girls. And yet some of them have broken *Fear Factor* records." They're conscious of the *Sita-aur-Gita* blend—the girls say the Gayatri Mantra before they head off to drive cars that fly up to the second floor. They also have the killer instinct—whether it is Iris Maity who won *Get Gorgeous 5* and thought nothing of abusing fellow contestant in the "survival of the fittest", or 19-year-old Shambvi Sharma, a *Roadies 5.0* contestant (an Amity Law College student who has gone on to a role in a Bollywood movie) who flirted outrageously with the boys as part of her "strategy to survive in the game" and whose seductive ladyboy dance (complete with her slapping her behind) is a highly downloadable YouTube clip.

It's enough to give the boys a complex. Bani says she often gets stopped by girls who tell her their boyfriends are huge fans and Shambhvi says it's time boys got scared of girls. It's like the wildly popular Meow of *Jaane Tu... Ya Jaane Na* who thinks nothing of letting out a stream of abuse and scratching her opponent's cheek while her best friend, a boy called Rats, lectures sweetly on the virtues of non-violence. Girls mouthing off has become not only acceptable but official ever since Kareena Kapoor's dumped woman let out a stream of abuse at her truant boyfriend on the phone in *Jab We Met*—and got him back, only to have the satisfaction of dumping him. As Bani says, "When *Roadies* came out, my grandmother asked me why the bell rang every two seconds while I would speak." (It was MTV beeping out her favourite cuss word). Let's hear it for new Heroine Hunterwali. Beep. ■



Kaun Banega Crorepati, she does only what she pleases. Or take the spirited Woodstockian, Gurbani Judge (Bani), finalist of *Roadies 4.0* and now an MTV veejay, who is proud she can support her family at all of 20—she also thought nothing of taking her father to court, along with her elder sister, for maintenance when she was a minor.

It's a side of the new woman that has surprised even a television veteran like Ashvini Yardi, programming head, Colors. "*Khatron ke Khiladi* was 16 days of virtual boot camp in South

MTV Splitsvilla



Twenty girls were supposed to win the attentions of two boys but the men look like wusses as mean girls mouth off and mud wrestle to vanquish each other

"Some fights are so provocative they can't even be aired. All for a chance to host a show." Ashish Patil, MTV

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